

Infinite Dark Dimensions in Geometric Harmony: From Simple Rules Beyond the Standard Model

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Abstract

String theory adds 6 or 7 extra dimensions at a specification cost exceeding 3,000 bits. This paper argues the opposite: an infinite tower of geometric dimensions exists above any manifold with a metric, each at zero additional algorithmic cost. The metric bundle (14D) over a 4D manifold is mathematically necessary, not specified. The jet bundle above the metric bundle is mathematically necessary. The tower continues without bound. No specification. No compactification. No landscape. Zero bits.

The argument requires only three assumptions: the fundamental description is discrete, has a simple local update rule, and the rule is applied iteratively. These are the minimal assumptions of any computational substrate. Hypergraph rewriting rules, cellular automata, causal sets, and spin networks all satisfy them. SDP is agnostic about which substrate wins. It predicts only that the winning rule has the lowest Kolmogorov complexity among those producing observer-supporting physics.

The physics is not in the dimension count but in the amplitude profile. Like modes on a vibrating string, the fundamental (metric bundle) dominates observable physics. Higher modes contribute progressively smaller corrections. The Standard Model is the timbre. This reframes effective field theory as a consequence of the harmonic structure of necessary geometry, not as an approximation to unknown deeper physics.

Keywords: harmonic geometry, geometric harmony, simple rules, extra dimensions, algorithmic complexity, string theory, metric bundle, effective field theory, Simplicity Dominance Principle, dark matter, hierarchy problem

1. The Anti-String-Theory

String theory and geometric harmony make opposite moves on the same problem.

String theory: Start with 10 or 11 dimensions. The extra dimensions are not automatically there. They must be specified: which Calabi-Yau manifold (six-dimensional shape), which flux configuration (fields through it), which moduli stabilization (fixing its size). The landscape of $\sim 10^500$ possible specifications is the tell. Each choice adds bits. Total additional specification: 3,000 to 4,700 bits

beyond 4D. Under the Simplicity Dominance Principle (SDP), each bit halves the measure. String theory describes a structure exponentially disfavored.

Geometric harmony: Start with 4D and a metric. A metric is a symmetric 4×4 matrix: 10 independent numbers specifying how to measure distance at a point. 4 spacetime coordinates plus 10 metric components = 14 dimensions. The metric bundle is automatically there. Weinstein’s Geometric Unity (2021) proposed that gauge structure and gravity emerge from this 14D geometry (Bernstein, 2026m). Whether his specific construction succeeds is open. That the 14D exists at zero cost is mathematical fact. Above it, the first jet bundle is automatically there: the space of all possible first derivatives of the metric. Above that, the second jet bundle. The tower continues without bound. Each level adds zero algorithmic complexity because each follows from the one below by mathematical necessity. It exists because calculus exists.

String theory: finite extra dimensions, enormous K cost. Harmonic geometry: infinite extra dimensions, zero K cost.

The inversion is total. String theory must justify its dimensions. Harmonic geometry must explain why its infinite dimensions produce finite, specific physics. The answer is the amplitude profile.

The irony is that string theory’s deepest insight survives. Physics IS a spectrum of vibrational modes. The particle zoo IS a harmonic series. String theory heard correctly. It guessed the instrument: tiny objects vibrating in compactified dimensions. Harmonic geometry identifies the actual instrument: the overtone structure of necessary geometry. The modes that string theory postulates, harmonic geometry derives. The strings were always there. They were derivative dimensions, not spatial ones.

2. From Simple Rules to Manifolds

The argument requires three assumptions about the fundamental description:

1. It is discrete (finite description).
2. It has a simple local update rule (few bits).
3. The rule is applied iteratively (computation).

These are the minimal assumptions of any computational substrate. Hypergraph rewriting rules (Wolfram, 2020), cellular automata (Wolfram, 2002; Zuse, 1969), causal sets (Bombelli et al., 1987), spin networks (Penrose, 1971), and lambda calculus (Church, 1936) all satisfy them. SDP is agnostic about which substrate wins. It predicts only that the winning rule has the lowest K among those producing observer-supporting physics. The substrate is the variable. The K is the criterion.

A simple rule applied iteratively to a discrete structure produces growth. Coarse-graining at large scales produces a manifold with effective dimensionality. This has been demonstrated explicitly for hypergraph rules (Gorard, 2020) and is

conjectured for other substrates. The key result: causal invariance of the update rule produces the discrete analog of general covariance, yielding general relativity in the continuum limit.

The manifold has a metric (the causal graph provides distance, the coarse-grained structure provides smooth geometry). The metric is not imposed. It emerges from the update rule's causal structure.

The chain so far: simple rule $\rightarrow$ iteration $\rightarrow$ discrete structure $\rightarrow$ coarse-graining $\rightarrow$ manifold with metric. Total K: the length of the rule.

3. From Manifolds to the Harmonic Tower

The 14D metric bundle (§1) is the first level. The 4D manifold alone gives gravity. The 10 extra dimensions provide geometric space for gauge structure. This is the minimum complete description: going shorter misses gauge forces.

Why does the tower extend infinitely above 14D? Metrics are smooth functions. Smooth functions have derivatives. First derivatives of 10 metric components in 4 directions yield 40 new components: the first jet bundle has $14+40=54$ dimensions. Second derivatives add 100 more: 154 dimensions. Third, fourth, without end. Each level exists automatically because smooth functions are infinitely differentiable. Each adds zero K. The tower ends only if smoothness ends. In continuum physics, it never does. The tower exists because calculus exists.

String theory's extra dimensions are spatial and must be chosen from $\sim 10^5$ topologies. The harmonic tower's dimensions are derivative structures that exist by the definition of smooth geometry. Choice versus necessity. Specification versus mathematics.

4. The Amplitude Profile

A vibrating string has a fundamental frequency and infinite overtones. All are physically present. Each is quieter. The timbre, what distinguishes a violin from a trumpet, is the amplitude profile.

The geometric tower has the same structure. The metric bundle is the fundamental. Higher geometric structures are higher modes. All are present (mathematically necessary). Each contributes less to observable physics. The Standard Model is the timbre.

This is how physics already works. Effective field theory (EFT) says: write all terms consistent with your symmetries, organize by dimension, lowest terms dominate at low energies, higher terms contribute suppressed corrections. Nobody derived EFT from first principles. It works.

Harmonic geometry explains why. Each EFT term corresponds to a level of the geometric tower. The suppression is the natural falloff of higher modes:

they correspond to higher-order geometric structure that contributes less to the coarse-grained physics observers access. EFT is the exact description of how infinite automatic geometry projects onto finite observable physics.

The Pythagoreans called it the music of the spheres. Harmonic geometry is the derivation.

5. Testable Consequences

The following consequences follow from the harmonic tower. Quantitative derivation is the open program.

Dark matter as first overtone. The metric bundle contains gauge structure (visible matter) and gravitational dynamics. The first jet bundle above it contains derivative structure that couples gravitationally but not to Standard Model gauge fields. These degrees of freedom would be massive, stable, gravitationally interacting, and gauge-invisible. That is the observational profile of dark matter. No new particles. Overlooked geometry that was always there at zero K cost.

The MOND connection. Milgrom's Modified Newtonian Dynamics fits galaxy rotation curves with one parameter: a critical acceleration $a_0 \sim cH/2$, proportional to the Hubble constant. Nobody explains why. Under harmonic geometry, this is natural: the first overtone becomes significant at the cosmological scale. a_0 marks where the first geometric overtone becomes audible above the fundamental. Geometric dark matter would interpolate between MOND-like behavior at galaxy scales and particle-like behavior at cluster scales, potentially unifying both approaches. MOND works at galaxy scale because it approximates the overtone. It fails at cluster scale because the approximation breaks down where higher modes contribute.

Gravitational memory as second observable face. Gravitational wave memory (the Christodoulou effect) is a permanent metric displacement after a wave passes. Strominger showed that memory, BMS supertranslations, and soft graviton theorems are three faces of one result, all involving metric derivative degrees of freedom. The jet bundle describes these same degrees of freedom locally at every point, while BMS describes them at the boundary of spacetime. Both belong to the same mathematical family. If they are related through holography, dark matter and gravitational memory would be two observable faces of the first geometric overtone: one seen through galactic dynamics, one through gravitational wave detectors. LIGO and LISA observations would then cross-check dark matter predictions. This connection is structural, not derived. Quantitative proof requires showing that bulk jet bundle excitations project onto the boundary as BMS modes.

More broadly, the holographic principle, that a boundary encodes the bulk, may be a special case of a stronger result derivable from calculus. These are three distinct senses of encoding: Turing encoding maps any dimension to one,

preserving data but not physics. The holographic principle preserves physics within entropy bounds. For an analytic metric, the infinite jet bundle at a single point reconstructs the full geometry exactly.

Dark energy as background mode. The cosmological constant corresponds to the zeroth-order geometric contribution: the volume of spacetime itself. Its smallness (120 orders of magnitude below naive predictions) may reflect its position in the harmonic series: a DC offset suppressed by the same mechanism that suppresses all higher modes relative to the gauge-gravitational fundamental.

The hierarchy problem as amplitude ratio. Gravity is 10^{38} times weaker than electromagnetism. Gravity emerges from the metric itself (the base). Gauge forces emerge from the metric bundle (the fundamental mode). The hierarchy may be the natural gap between base and first mode of geometric structure.

Three generations as harmonic structure. Three fermion generations are unexplained in the Standard Model. Each generation may correspond to a mode of the metric bundle's internal structure, with three being the count above the noise floor at accessible energies.

6. Falsification

The framework predicts:

1. No new forces beyond the geometric tower. Discovery of a force with no geometric origin would challenge it.
2. Dark matter is geometric, not particulate. Detection of a dark matter particle with gauge interactions would falsify the mode interpretation.
3. Higher-energy corrections follow the mode amplitude profile. Deviations from the predicted suppression pattern would challenge the picture.
4. No landscape. The physics is unique because the harmonic series is unique. Meta-stable vacua with different low-energy physics would favor string theory.

7. The Full Chain

Simple rule (any substrate, few bits) $\rightarrow$ iteration $\rightarrow$ discrete structure $\rightarrow$ coarse-graining $\rightarrow$ 4D manifold with metric $\rightarrow$ metric bundle (14D, automatic) $\rightarrow$ infinite tower of jet bundles and connection bundles (each automatic) $\rightarrow$ amplitude profile dominated by fundamental $\rightarrow$ Standard Model + corrections

Total algorithmic cost: the length of the rule. Everything else is mathematical necessity.

A clarification on what SDP predicts. It does not predict we observe the simplest possible physics. The simplest possible structure has no observers. SDP predicts that structures producible by shorter programs have exponentially higher measure, because a short program occupies a larger fraction of program-space.

We observe ~200 bits of physics, not 10 and not 200,000, because a generating rule of that complexity is short enough to have high measure while complex enough to produce observers. The prediction is statistical: we are more likely to find ourselves in a structure generated by a shorter program, because shorter programs occupy more of program-space. The same logic applies to temporal location: each observer-moment is a prefix, shorter prefixes have higher individual measure, but more observer-moments exist later. We find ourselves where these two pressures meet.

7. Connection to Superdeterminism

The infinite jet bundle has a further structural consequence. Under superdeterminism (Hossenfelder & Palmer, 2019), hidden variables correlated with measurement settings restore locality and determinism to quantum mechanics. The jet bundle tower provides a candidate substrate: the hidden variables are higher-dimensional geometric degrees of freedom, locally defined; once the base metric dynamics are fixed, jet components are fixed as derived quantities, adding no independent stochastic degrees of freedom. The correlation between measurement settings and hidden variables is not conspiratorial but geometric: both are aspects of the same metric configuration at different levels of the tower. A full development of this identification is given in Bernstein (2026o).

The chain developed across companion papers:

- Mathematical monism, SDP, arrow of time, variational dynamics, and geometric unity form a unified chain from mathematical necessity to physical structure (Bernstein, 2026c-o; see companion papers)
- Harmonics: the tower is infinite, automatic, and the source of all physics (this paper)

Each result follows from the same structural fact: mathematical necessity produces structure at zero algorithmic cost. The physics is in what dominates. Everything exists. Most of it is quiet.

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